terms of the Treaty of Yandabo, were withdrawn from Burma following ill-treatment at the court. Tharrawaddy died in November 1845 and his son, Pagan Min (r. ca. 1846–1853), ascended the throne at the age of 35. Pagan Min's reign was characterized by corruption and maladministration that effected Burmese and British alike. Any thought of a thaw in British-Burmese relations were quickly dashed as British merchants in Rangoon and Ava were fined and harassed by the governor of Pegu, Maung Ok. Tired of the harassment by Maung Ok, the merchants eventually sent a petition to Governor-General Lord Dalhousie, who dispatched Commodore George Lambert to Rangoon in December 1851 to negotiate the redress of grievances and demand compensation from the Burmese. Pagan Min immediately made concessions to the British, including the ouster of the governor of Rangoon, but, for reasons unknown, Commodore Lambert provoked a naval confrontation with the Burmese by blockading the port of Rangoon and seizing Pagan Min's royal ship, thus starting the second Anglo-Burmese war.

THE SECOND ANGLO-BURMESE WAR

The second Anglo-Burmese war (April 5, 1852–January 20, 1853) led to the British annexation of Lower Burma and the gradual loss of Burmese independence.

On April 5, 1852, joint British naval and ground forces captured the port of Martaban. The city of Rangoon fell on April 12, 1852, during which the Myoza of Tabayin, a son of General Maha Bandula, was killed. After heavy fighting, the Shwedagon pagoda was occupied on April 14, 1852, when the Burmese withdrew. On May 19, 1852, the city of Bassein fell to the British. On June 3, 1852, the British had seized Pegu. By October the British had occupied Prome. Lord Dalhousie wanted Pagan Min to recognize the British conquest of Lower Burma. Following Pagan Min's rejection of peace, Dalhousie annexed Pegu on December 20, 1852, by proclamation and appointed Major Arthur Phayre as commissioner. By annexing Pegu the British were able to extend their eastern frontier to the banks of the Salween River. Pagan Min was forced to abdicate the throne on February 18, 1853, in favor of his half brother Mindon Min (r. ca. 1853–1878), who immediately sought a cessation of hostilities. As a gesture of goodwill he